# The Hobbit: good morning

TASK 1

## Books and films

**Talk** with a partner.

1. Do you prefer reading a book or watching the film of it? Why?
2. Name a book you have read and also seen as a film. Which was better?
3. What do you know about *The Hobbit*?

TASK 2

## The scene

**Read** our short summary of the scene. **Answer** the questions.

One quiet morning a hobbit called Bilbo Baggins is standing at the round green door of his home, smoking his pipe and enjoying the sun. A tall old man stops in front of him. He has a long grey beard, a pointed hat and a stick: he is Gandalf, a wizard. Bilbo says good morning, and Gandalf asks him what exactly he means by it. Gandalf says he is looking for someone to join an adventure. Bilbo is not interested at all: adventures, he says, are uncomfortable and make you late for dinner. He tries politely to end the conversation and go back inside, but the old man does not move.

1. Where is Bilbo? _____
2. Who stops in front of him? _____
3. Does Bilbo want an adventure? _____

Adapted from: Vaughan-Spruce, R. (2012) 'The Hobbit', a demo lesson plan on *English Lesson Planner*. The scene: Tolkien, J.R.R. (1937) *The Hobbit*. London: George Allen & Unwin, chapter 1, and the film *The Hobbit: An Unexpected Journey* (2012). The summary is ours; the teacher reads the passage from the book.

TASK 3

## Listen to the book

Your teacher reads the scene from the book. **Listen** and **answer**.

1. How many times does Bilbo say good morning?

2. Is the second good morning friendly? Why does he say it?

3. What does Gandalf want?

TASK 4

## Watch the film

Your teacher plays the same scene from the film. **Don't look** at your notes. Was the film...

- ○ identical to the book
- ○ almost exactly the same
- ○ fairly similar
- ○ similar in some parts, different in others
- ○ very different

**Compare** with your group. Do you agree?

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TASK 5

## Same or different?

**Watch again.** Write two things that are the same in the book and the film, and two that are different.

| THE SAME | DIFFERENT |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |

TASK 6

## Good morning, four ways

**Listen** to your teacher. Then **say** *Good morning* in each of these ways. Can your partner guess which one?

| | |
| --- | --- |
| 1. **a friendly hello** | You meet a neighbour you like. |
| 2. **Go away, please** | You want the conversation to end. |
| 3. **Really? You again?** | You are surprised and not happy. |
| 4. **It IS a lovely morning** | The sun is out and you feel great. |

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TASK 7

## Words from the scene

**Guess** the meaning from the scene first. Then **match**.

1. **into the bargain** _____
2. **disturbing** _____
3. **to take no notice of** _____
4. **not quite my sort** _____
5. **to gaze** _____
6. **to get rid of** _____
7. **to move off** _____
8. **I suppose** _____
9. **that remains to be seen** _____

a. someone you don't really like
b. to look at someone or something for a long time
c. to go away
d. I think (but I'm not sure)
e. also
f. to ignore
g. to lose someone or something you don't want
h. I don't know yet
i. something that interrupts you

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TASK 8

## Your turn

**Ask** and **answer** with a partner.

1. What do you find most disturbing when you are working?
2. Who is not quite your sort, in films or in books?
3. What would you like to get rid of in your home?
4. Will you speak perfect English one day? That remains to be seen!

TASK 9

## A visitor at the door

**In pairs.** A: you are at home and want a quiet day. B: you knock on the door and invite A on an adventure. A: get rid of B politely. Then change.

Use: *Good morning… · I suppose… · Not quite my sort… · That remains to be seen… · I really must move off now.*

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